



Photography summer course

FX School's Junior Photography summer course is aimed at teaching photography using DSLRs to children of ages 10 to 14. <http://dgit.in/DslrSPHCr>



Leap in Translation

demand for translations to Telugu has increased by 37 per cent in Q1 2016 and is driven due to tech companies in Telangana.

Digit Squad

Association. The CTIA has recognised the AHJ, which stands for American Headset Jack wiring arrangement as their standard.

Both of these standards have the left audio wiring connected onto the tip and the right audio on the first ring, for stereo output. The wiring of the microphone and the grounding is where the difference lies.

The OMTP places the microphone on the second ring and the ground on the sleeve. On the other hand, the CTIA standard interchanges the OMTP placement of the microphone and the ground, connecting the ground onto the second ring and microphone to the sleeve.

Standard	Tip	Ring 1	Ring 2	Sleeve
OMTP	Left audio	Right audio	Microphone	Ground
CTIA/AHJ	Left audio	Right audio	Ground	Microphone

If your jack follows the OMTP standard, CTIA connectors will not be completely compatible and function as they should, as their contacts do not align correctly. For eg: Smartphone manufacturer OnePlus follows the OMTP standard for its phones where as Apple follows the CTIA standard for its iPhones. Crazy, isn't it?

Third party headphone manufacturers, thus, produce headsets that follow one of the standards and label the compatibility. Renowned headphone manufacturers like Sennheiser, Bose and others have compatibility charts available on their website. All you need to provide is information regarding your smartphone brand and the specific model, and the website shows the headphones that will be compatible with your device. There are plenty of converters available too, be it for converting OMTP to CTIA or from one size to another and a host of other combinations possible on earth.

Laptops, for the longest time provided (some of them continue to still do so) dedicated 3.5mm jacks for microphone as well as headphone but their slimming down has led to laptop manufacturers to compromise and provide a 3.5mm combo jack.

Types of audio connectors and their uses

The 6.3mm connector was used for years by telephone operators to patch telephone connections together. Also known as the quarter inch jack, this connector is now commonly found on musical equipments, especially in electric guitars and guitar amps. Like the 3.5mm connector and follows the Tip-Sleeve or the Tip-Ring-Sleeve arrangement, but is larger in length and diameter.

One of the most commonly used sizes and follows the Tip-Ring-Sleeve structure, allowing it to carry up to three analog signals at a time. Stereo, microphone-enabled or audio/video versions of this connector have additional rings to carry additional signals.

Banana plugs come in various sizes and have a metal pin that bulges out in the middle, resembling the shape of a banana. They are generally used in pairs and are found on higher-end amps and speakers and are used to connect the two.

Most commonly referred as the audio/video jacks, the RCA connectors are most commonly used to carry audio and video

signals and are 2mm thick. The shell is connected to the outer conductor of the cable providing electrical ground whereas the center pin of the plug is connected to the cable conductor that carries the signal. The RCA cables are color-coded, where yellow is for composite video, red is for right audio channel and white for the left channel of stereo audio.

Developed by Toshiba, optical interface for digital audio signal is called TOSLINK. It is a round optical connector housed in a rectangle connected body and was originally intended for use solely with Toshiba CD players. Later on, it was adopted by several manufacturers and has gone to become standard equipment on many audio/video sources, receivers and surround sound equipment. TOSLINK uses fiber optic cable but is limited to a maximum cable length of about 5 meters.

S/PDIF is another type of digital audio cable format that stands for 'Sony Philips Digital Interface' and can be used along with optical fiber connectors such as TOSLINK which converts the S/PDIF signal to light for transmission or with coaxial connectors like the RCA using adapters.

XLR connectors are circular in shape and are used for professional audio applications. The most common configuration for an XLR connector is 3-pin where the first pin provides grounding, the second one is the positive polarity terminal and the third is negative, to provide balanced audio signals. 



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